DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

TASK 5

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

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<u>Part A – Case Study</u>

Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

1. Introduction

UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud is a common cybercrime where attackers trick users into authorizing payments instead of receiving money. This type of fraud mainly relies on social engineering techniques.

2. How the Crime Happens (Step-by-Step)

1. The fraudster contacts the victim via phone, SMS, or messaging apps, posing as a buyer, seller, or bank official.
2. They build trust by offering an attractive deal or creating urgency.
3. A "collect request" is sent through a UPI app, claiming the victim needs to approve it to receive money.
4. The victim enters their UPI PIN, thinking they are accepting payment.
5. Instead of receiving money, the amount gets deducted from their account.

3. Targeted Victims

Students, elderly individuals, and people unfamiliar with digital payment systems are the most common targets of this fraud.

4. Consequences

Victims may suffer financial loss, emotional distress, and reduced trust in digital platforms. In serious cases, large amounts of money can be lost.

5. Prevention Measures

This fraud can be prevented by understanding that entering a UPI PIN always means sending money. Users should verify all payment requests carefully and avoid sharing sensitive information online.

Part B – Prevention Checklist

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

General Safety Tips

- Use strong and unique passwords for all accounts; avoid using the same password everywhere.
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on important apps like email, banking, and social media.
- Do not click on suspicious links or download files from unknown sources.
- Be cautious while using public Wi-Fi; avoid logging into banking or personal accounts on unsecured networks.
- Regularly update your apps and operating system to protect against security vulnerabilities.
- Think before sharing personal information (phone number, address, college details) online.

Financial / UPI Safety Tips

- Never enter your UPI PIN to receive money—UPI PIN is only required to send money.
- Do not approve unknown "collect requests" on apps like Google Pay, PhonePe, or Paytm.
- Avoid scanning QR codes from unknown or untrusted sources.

- Do not share OTPs, UPI PIN, or bank details with anyone, even if they claim to be from the bank.

Reporting Cybercrime

- Report any cybercrime immediately at the National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Call the Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 for urgent financial fraud assistance.